
HMO Compliance Checklist

HMOs out-earn single lets because they carry more obligation — licensing, fire safety, minimum standards. None of it is difficult; all of it is mandatory. Confirm the licensing position before you buy, not after.

01 Before purchase

- ☐ Mandatory licensing applies at 5+ occupants from 2+ households — check your council's additional and selective schemes too
 - ☐ Article 4 direction check: C4 planning permission may be required for a new HMO
 - ☐ Minimum room sizes: 6.51m² single, 10.22m² double (councils can set higher)
 - ☐ Amenity ratios: kitchens, bathrooms and WCs per occupant to your council's standard
 - ☐ Existing HMO: ask for the current licence and any inspection reports
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02 Fire safety

- ☐ Interlinked mains-powered smoke detection to the appropriate grade, heat detector in kitchen
 - ☐ 30-minute fire doors with closers on habitable rooms and kitchen
 - ☐ Protected escape route with emergency lighting where required
 - ☐ Fire blanket in kitchen; extinguishers where your risk assessment requires
 - ☐ A written fire risk assessment, reviewed annually
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03 Certificates & records

- ☐ Gas safety certificate — annually
 - ☐ EICR electrical report — five-yearly
 - ☐ PAT testing for any appliances you supply
 - ☐ EPC rated E or better (check current minimum standard)
 - ☐ Deposit protection and prescribed information within 30 days
 - ☐ Right to Rent checks documented for every occupant
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04 Ongoing management

- ☐ Licence conditions diarised: inspections, waste arrangements, occupancy limits
 - ☐ Quarterly property inspection with photos and log
 - ☐ Manager's contact details displayed in the property
 - ☐ Renewal dates tracked: licence, certificates, insurance — a shared calendar, not memory
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